Name _____

# The Human Cheek Cell

1. List the 3 parts of the Cell Theory

2. Write a short description of each of the following:

--cell membrane

--cytoplasm

--nucleus

--organelle

--eukaryote

--cytoskeleton

**Procedure:**

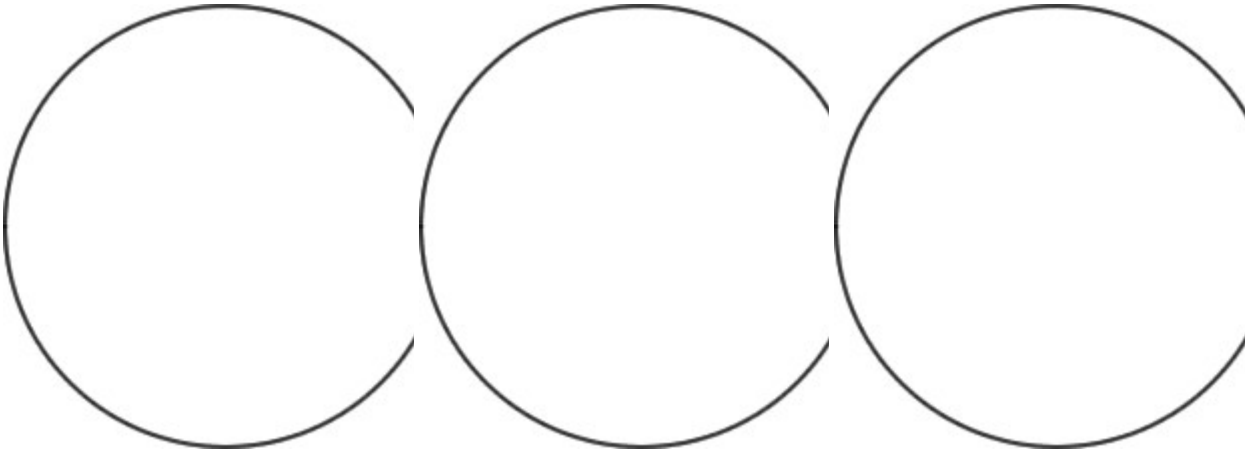
Procedure:
1. Wash the underside of a wrist that will be sampled for epidermal cells with soap and water.
2. Stick a clean piece of clear tape on the underside of the washed wrist.
3. Gently remove the piece of tape from the wrist being careful to avoid getting fingerprints on the tape. A forceps might help to remove the tape and avoid fingerprinting the tape.
4. Place the tape, sticky-side up, on a clean microscope slide.
5. Stain the top, sticky side of the tape with 2 or 3 drops of 1% methylene blue solution.
6. Use a dissecting needle to gently place a cover slip over the sticky tape. Lower the coverslip down onto the tape and then remove the dissecting needle. This should help prevent staining your fingers. Caution: Use methylene blue carefully. It will stain most items including skin, clothing, and table tops.
7. Examine the slide under a microscope. Look for cells with low power first, and then switch to high power for details.

6. Switch to low power. Cells should be visible, but they will be small and look like nearly clear purplish blobs.If you are looking at something dark dark purple, it is probably not a cell

7. Once you think you have located a cell, switch to high power and refocus.(Remember, do NOT use the coarse adjustment knob at this point)

---**Sketch** the cell at low and high power.Label the nucleus, cytoplasm, and cell membrane. Draw your cells to scale.

Scanning Low High



3.Why is methylene blue necessary?

4.Cheek cells do not move on their own, so you will not find two organelles that function for cell movement. Name these organelles.

5.The light microscope used in the lab is not powerful enough to view other organelles in the cheek cell.What parts of the cell were visible.

6. List 2 organelles that were NOT visible but should have been in the cheek cell.

7.Is the cheek cell a eukaryote or prokaryote? How do you know?

8. Keeping in mind that the mouth is the first site of chemical digestion in a human.Your saliva starts the provss of breaking down the food you eat.Keeping this in mind, what organelle do you think would bem numerous inside the cells of your mouth?